PRACTICAL GUIDE · 2026 EDITION

Make videos by asking Claude.

How to install OpenFilm, create your first video, and edit it — by dragging clips in Studio or by simply telling Claude what to change.

```
$ npx skills add openfilm/openfilm
```


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01 · WHAT IS OPENFILM

A video editor that Claude can drive.

OpenFilm is a skill for Claude. Once it's installed, you describe the video you want and Claude builds it — every shot, the music and the cuts — and opens it in an editor where you can watch and change everything.

How it works

A film is one web page, `film.html`. Each shot is its own small page drawn in code, and footage, pictures and sound are clips placed on a timeline.

Because it's all plain files, Claude can read and change any part of it precisely.

What you can make

- Launch and promo videos
- Explainers and tutorials
- Reels and Shorts (9:16)
- Motion graphics and title cards
- Edits of your own footage

02 · WHAT YOU NEED

Before you start

REQUIREMENT	WHY	NOTES
Claude Code	Claude runs the skill and does the editing	Terminal, desktop app or IDE extension
Node.js	Provides `npx`, which installs and runs OpenFilm	Current LTS from nodejs.org
A modern browser	OpenFilm Studio opens in your browser	Chrome, Edge, Safari or Firefox
Internet (first run)	Downloads OpenFilm and a render browser	The render browser is ~115 MB, once
Your own API key (optional)	Only for AI voice-over, music, images or video	ElevenLabs, OpenAI, Google and others

Good to know: everything else — shots, animation, title cards, edits — works with no extra keys. Claude can even generate simple music and sound effects in code.

03 · INSTALL

One command. That's it.

Open a terminal in the folder of your project (or any folder you like) and run:

```
$ npx skills add openfilm/openfilm
◇ Cloning repository…
✓ Installed 1 skill · openfilm
```

This adds the skill to the project (`.agents/skills/openfilm`) and links it for Claude Code (`.claude/skills/openfilm`). Start, or restart, Claude Code in that folder and the skill is available.

> **Tip:** commit these files to your repository so the skill comes with the project on every machine and every session.

04 · YOUR FIRST VIDEO

Just ask Claude

Describe what you want in plain words — any language works. Be specific about length, shape and style:

Make a 20-second launch video for my app, 16:9, dark and cinematic.

Make a vertical 9:16 Reel explaining what an AI agent is, with captions.

నాకు ఒక launch video చేయి.

1. **Claude creates a project**
   A new folder named after your film, with `film.html` inside.

2. **It writes every shot**
   Each shot becomes its own page; footage, pictures and sound go in `assets/`.

3. **It checks its own work**
   Claude looks at a contact sheet of the whole film and fixes anything off before showing you.

05 · OPENFILM STUDIO

Watch every change land, live.

Studio is OpenFilm's editor. It opens in your browser with a preview on top and a timeline below, and it updates the moment Claude changes the film.

Opening Studio

Claude opens it for you when it starts a film. To open it yourself:

```
$ npx -y openfilm@latest open my-film # a new film gets its own folder
$ npx -y openfilm@latest open # reopen the film you're in, or the last one
```

It prints Studio's address; open it in your browser and keep it open while you work with Claude.

What's in a project

```
my-film/
├── film.html     ← the film: tracks of clips on a timeline
├── title.html    ← one shot, drawn in code
├── shot-2.html   ← another shot
├── assets/       ← video, pictures and sound
└── .film/        ← Studio's own settings — leave it alone
```

Reading the timeline

Tracks

Each row is a track. Tracks higher up are drawn on top — titles above footage, background at the bottom.

Clips

A clip is a shot page, a video, a picture or a sound. Clips on one track never overlap.

Locked tracks

Lock a track in Studio and Claude won't touch anything on it. Use this to protect your own edits.

Hidden & muted

Hide a track to stop it showing, or mute it to silence it, without deleting anything.

06 · EDITING, TWO WAYS

Drag it, or just say it.

① In Studio

- Drag a clip to move it in time
- Drag a clip's edges to trim it
- Move clips between tracks
- Edit text and elements on the picture

② Tell Claude

- Describe the change in plain words
- Claude changes only what you asked
- Your Studio edits are kept
- Watch it update live in Studio

Things you can ask for

Make the title stay on screen longer.

Swap shots 2 and 3.

Speed up the intro.

Cut the part where I repeat myself in clip 4.

Make the captions bigger and move the logo to the top right.

What changes under the hood

Every request becomes a small, precise change in `film.html`. Knowing these helps you ask for exactly what you want:

SETTING	WHAT IT CONTROLS	EXAMPLE
Trim	Which seconds of a clip play	`clip.mp4#t=2,8` plays 2 s to 8 s
at	Where a clip starts in the film	`at="12.5"`
speed	Faster or slower, 0.25× to 4×	`speed="1.5"`
volume	A clip's loudness (1 = original)	`volume="0.3"` for music under voice
Position	Where a clip sits and its size	`left`, `top`, `width`, `rotate`

No quality loss: trimming never cuts or re-encodes your footage. Every clip is the same original file with its own in and out points.

07 · VOICE, MUSIC & CAPTIONS

Add sound with your own keys.

AI voice-over, music, sound effects, transcripts and images come from services you connect with your own API key.

1

Open Settings

In Studio, click the OpenFilm logo at the top left.

2

Connect a provider

Under **Providers**, add your key for a service.

3

Pick models

Under **Services**, choose which model makes each kind of media.

YOU WANT	SERVICES THAT MAKE IT
Voice-over	ElevenLabs, OpenAI, Google, Microsoft Azure, Groq, Xiaomi MiMo
Music & sound effects	ElevenLabs, fal.ai
Transcripts / captions	ElevenLabs, OpenAI, Google, Groq, Doubao, Xiaomi MiMo
Images & video	OpenAI, Google, fal.ai · image search: Pexels, Pixabay

Already have a voice-over? Just give Claude the file. It places it on the timeline and times the captions to your words. Captions are styled in Studio — size, colour, position and a word-by-word highlight.

08 · EXPORT & SHARE

Get your MP4

From Studio

Use **Export** to save the finished video, with subtitles burned in if you want them.

Or ask Claude

"Render the video" — it saves an MP4 next to `film.html`.

```
$ npx -y openfilm@latest render # 30 fps MP4 beside film.html
$ npx -y openfilm@latest render --subtitles # captions burned in
```

09 · TIPS & FIXES

Work faster, avoid surprises.

Pro tips

Say the shape first

"9:16 for Reels" or "16:9 for YouTube" before anything else — the layout depends on it.

One request at a time

Small, clear changes are easier to check and undo than one long list.

Lock what you love

Lock a track in Studio once it's perfect, so later changes can't touch it.

Name your clips

"Clip 4", "the title", "the intro" — Claude follows the names you use.

Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	FIX
Skill not found	Restart Claude Code in the folder where you ran the install command.
Studio didn't open	Run `npx -y openfilm@latest open` and open the printed address yourself.
"Not connected" for voice/music	Add your key in Studio → Settings → Providers.
A clip won't play in the preview	Ask Claude to check it; some generated videos need a one-time re-encode for the browser.
Telugu/Hindi captions look broken	Install a font for that script (e.g. Noto Sans Telugu) and restart Studio.

Cheat sheet

```
$ npx skills add openfilm/openfilm     # install the skill
$ npx -y openfilm@latest open my-film # open or create a film
$ npx -y openfilm@latest look          # contact sheet of the film
$ npx -y openfilm@latest render        # export an MP4
```

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